

STEEL REMAINS THE backbone of India's infrastructure and industrial ambitions, powering everything from highways and railways to homes and automobiles. Yet, the sector also sits at the centre of the global climate debate as one of the world's largest carbon emitters. As India prepares for a massive infrastructure and manufacturing buildout over the next two decades, Tata Steel is attempting to answer a difficult question—can a steelmaker continue to grow aggressively without sharply increasing its carbon footprint?

44 | The answer, according to Rajiv Mangal, the Vice President of Safety, Health, and Sustainability, Tata Steel, lies in reimagining what “green steel” means for a fast-growing economy like India. It has been recognised as the Most Sustainable Company in Metals & Mining in the category of Sectoral Excellence in Manufacturing in this year's *BT* India's Most Sustainable Companies. Speaking to *Business Today*, Mangal says India's steel demand is only at the beginning of a long growth cycle. “India's per capita steel consumption is less than half the global average. As a developing nation, demand for steel will continue to grow for at least the next two decades.”

Unlike Western economies, where steel demand has largely stabilised, India faces the dual challenge of sustaining industrial growth while transitioning towards low-carbon manufacturing. “The challenge for steel companies is how to plan growth and green steel without creating stranded assets, because steel is an extremely capital-intensive business and with one wrong move



GREENING INDIA'S STEEL BACKBONE

From green steel and circularity to water positivity and waste-to-value initiatives, Tata Steel is placing long-term bets on sustainability practices

BY PALAK AGARWAL